

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦ J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦ 4

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦ 7

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥ J

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥ J

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦ 6

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6
♥ A 9 7 3
♦ Q 7
♣ K J 8 6 2

♠ K Q J 4 2

♥ K 5

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7 5 3



♠ 10 8 5
♥ 6 4
♦ J 10 9 4 3
♣ A 10 9

♠ A 7 3

♥ Q J 10 8 2

♦ K 8 6

♣ Q 4

NORTH's 2♦ bid is New Minor Forcing.

NORTH chose ♦s rather than ♣s simply because the ♦s were stronger.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♦J			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 8 4
♥ K Q 8 4
♦ Q 5 2
♣ 7 6 3

♠ Q 10 7 3 2

♥ 10 3

♦ 10 7 3

♣ A K 9

	N	
W		E
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♠ K 5
♥ A J 9 6 2
♦ A K
♣ J 8 5 2

♠ A 9 6

♥ 7 5

♦ J 9 8 6 4

♣ Q 10 4

EAST is unlikely to win 10 tricks if WEST has three
♣ losers.

EAST's 3♣ bid is a Help Suit Game try. With no
help in ♣s and no ruffing values, WEST's 8 points
are not enough to think of game, so WEST signs off
in 3♥.

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥			
All Pass			
3♥ by East			
Lead: ♦4			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 5 3

♥ A

♦ 9 7 3 2

♣ 10 8 6 5

♠ K 8

♥ Q 8 5

♦ J 8 4

♣ A K J 7 3



♠ 9 4

♥ J 7 6 3 2

♦ A 10 5

♣ Q 9 2

♠ A J 7 6 2

♥ K 10 9 4

♦ K Q 6

♣ 4

NORTH's 3♦ bid is Fourth Suit Forcing and does NOT show a ♦ stopper.

The bid asks SOUTH to further describe her hand. SOUTH does not have a rebiddable suit, but does have ♦s stopped so she bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦7			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ A Q 5
 ♦ K 10 9 4 3
 ♣ K 10 7

♠ 10 4 3
 ♥ K J 10 8 4
 ♦ 7
 ♣ J 9 5 2



♠ Q 9 6 5 2
 ♥ 7 6 3
 ♦ A Q
 ♣ Q 8 4

♠ A K J
 ♥ 9 2
 ♦ J 8 6 5 2
 ♣ A 6 3

EAST cannot rebid the 5-card ♠ suit, cannot support WEST's ♦s, and cannot bid Notrump without a ♥ stopper.

So she bids 3♣, New Minor Forcing, asking WEST to describe his hand further.

WEST doesn't have three ♠s, nor does he have four ♥s. But he does have ♥s stopped, so bids 2NT. East is not strong enough to bid game so she passes.

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	1♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2NT			
All Pass			
2NT by West			
Lead: ♥J			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8
♥ K Q 8 6
♦ Q 7 2
♣ J 10 8 3

♠ A K 10 6 2

♥ A 4 3

♦ K 9 6 4

♣ 7



♠ 9 7
♥ J 10 9 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q 9 4

♠ Q 5 4 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A J 10 3

♣ 6 5 2

NORTH's 3♦ bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH has excellent help in ♦s so with 8 points he bids the game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♦

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♥J

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 8 3
 ♥ A Q J 7
 ♦ J 9
 ♣ K 10 2

♠ 9 7 6 2

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A 10 5 3

♣ J 5



♠ A 10 5
 ♥ 10 4
 ♦ K Q 7 4
 ♣ A 8 6 3

♠ K 4

♥ K 6 5 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ Q 9 7 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♦	Pass
1 ♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♦ 6			

WEST has no reason to consider New Minor Forcing with this hand.

EAST does not have four ♥s or he would have already supported, and he does not have four ♠s or he would not have bid 1NT.

So WEST should bid the Notrump game.